SHEPARD RODGERS

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EDUCATION

Tufts University, Medford, MA — September 2023 - May 2027 (expected)

MAJORS: Computer Science & STS (Science, Technology, and Society) — 3.95 GPA
RELEVANT COURSEWORK: How Systems Fail, Machine Learning, RL, Philosophy of Technology
EXTRACURRICULARS: Tufts AI Safety (Technical Director), The Lantern - Tech Impact Publication (E-Board), CubeSat Team, JumboCode - Nonprofit SWE, Campus-Wide AI Forum Planning Committee

EXPERIENCE

Public Interest Technology - New England | Impact Tech Fellow — May 2025 – June 2025
Gemini API, Prompt Engineering, Agile, NLP, Data Wrangling, React, MySQL — *Boston, MA*

- Led a 5-person team developing an LLM-powered civic tool for Dorchester's 26-block Talbot Norfolk Triangle, serving 2,000+ residents with insights from 5 years of public safety data and 3 years of community meeting transcripts.
- Applied Agile development practices, conducted dozens of code reviews, and facilitated weekly stakeholder meetings and on-site community engagement to align product features with lived experience and local safety concerns.
- Collected and sanitized public safety data for Gemini integration, and developed a React-based frontend with geospatial visualizations to make these insights accessible to residents.

Tufts AI Safety Student Association (TASSA) | Technical Director — February 2025 - Present
Organizational Strategy, Group Facilitation, Technical Communication — *Medford, MA*

- Established organizational focus as a founding executive board member, authoring the organization's constitution and defining strategic priorities to scale high-impact engagement with AI risk reduction.
- Designed and facilitated a selective 8-week technical fellowship that bridges the gap between deep learning and International Relations policy frameworks for interdisciplinary cohorts.
- Secured and managed a $\$10k$ operating budget as a Pathfinder Fellow, synthesizing input from global safety organizations to implement best practices for student upskilling and career mentorship.

Tufts University, Department of Computer Science | Teaching Assistant — January 2024 - Present
C, C++, Assembly, Cache Analysis, Technical Communication, Debugging, Architecture Review — *Medford, MA*

- Evaluate the structure and organization of students' code, including modularity, documentation, and formatting.
- Debug C++, C, and Assembly code at the machine level, focusing on computer architecture and modular programming.
- Teach coding skills and abstraction through weekly labs, online forums, and review sessions.
- Courses: "Machine Structure/Assembly Programming" and "Intro to Computer Science".

PROJECTS

De-scripting Coding Assistants in the Open Source Community | *Sociotechnical Research & Economic Analysis*

- Authored a paper synthesizing the history of automation and STS frameworks to propose new sustainable incentive models for open-source developers facing the rise of AI coding assistants.

Gomoku Reinforcement Learning Agent | *Python, PyTorch, NumPy, Deep RL*

- Engineered an Actor-Critic Deep RL agent to learn Gomoku through self-play, with custom policy/value networks.
- Optimized model through hyperparameter tuning and reward shaping, consistently outperforming a heuristic opponent.

Theatre@First Inventory System | *React, TypeScript, User-Centric Design*

- Developed a full-stack inventory system for a non-profit, streamlining data retrieval via a dynamic UI.

SKILLS

Technical Governance	Sociotechnical Analysis, Policy Drafting, Risk Assessment, Strategy, Stakeholder Management
AI & Research	LLM Evaluation, Prompt Engineering, Data Wrangling, PyTorch, BERT, Qualitative Analysis
Languages & Tools	Python, SQL, LaTeX, C/C++, SML, Scheme, Git(Hub), React, Agile Methodologies, DSA